

Jose Maria Barbeito

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Autobiography

As the oldest of five, I was brought up with a large amount of responsibility. I've taken many roles, including handyman, counselor, peacemaker, and leader, and learned to live in the chaos of a seven-person family. Being raised on a farm, I've had to make, fix, and design everything imaginable. I've built sheds and fences, fixed chicken coops and air conditioning units, re-routed plumbing and re-wired light switches; I've kept bees (still do!), skinned rabbits and delivered lambs on a cold February morning.

My parents immigrated from Argentina and brought with them a culture and heritage that will stay with me. My family has been immersed in a diverse local community that includes families from all over the world. Two years ago, I traveled alone to Argentina to work on a cattle ranch, an experience I will never forget. There, I worked and rode alongside *gauchos* eight hours a day, vaccinating cattle and sharing fireside country *asados*; this opportunity allowed me to understand and appreciate my heritage like never before.

This past summer, I traveled the world. Through 18 flights, countless hours within busses, and many many car trips, I visited five different countries, seeing the vast Australian outback, the Swiss Alps, the French countryside, the Great Barrier Reef, the Highlands of Scotland, and sprawling cities such as London and Paris. The experience as a whole gave me the opportunity to grow as a person and discover more about myself.

I love doing chemistry and using engineering to do fun projects. I am super excited for CHE 205 because it is the perfect class to experience what it would be like to use engineering and chemistry together in real life scenarios.